

Buzz

India's very first E-Library and other exciting developments of the past month

**Robot Olympics 2020**

Tokyo is planning to have the Robot Olympics 2020 where robots from all over the world can compete on technical skills <http://dgit.in/RobotOlympics>

✉ Dear Robert,

First of all, I appreciate you and your team's work in bringing out such a cool magazine!

I would like to make a suggestion. It's about Linux. I'm sure Digit can enlighten Windows users about why they should try Linux. Under the 'Hardware Review' section, you could add a section dedicated to Linux, mentioning how well the stuff will work under Linux, and what were the (probably tedious) steps taken to get the system to work. It needn't be too technical, because such a write-up will help everyone who's looking to buy hardware that they can run with Linux (and Windows together) without complications or compromises. Even on the Digit.in website, in laptop reviews you could have a "Linux Compatibility" section for each laptop detailing the wild things the author might have done while setting up a popular distribution. This will definitely complement the write-up well.

I hope you'll consider this suggestion. And even if you don't, you can still do one little thing to help penguin lovers: Specifically list in detail about each component used in a particular hardware. For example, in a laptop, if you look at the wireless chipset on its website, the manufacturer just lists something like "802.11 b/g/n" and that's the end of story. But just that information isn't enough to deduce the Linux compatibility of that laptop. We'll need to know what brand it is and the exact serial number of the model. Another useful detail most of them exclude is related to graphics card. Most of the newer laptops come with a hybrid hardware-MUXless configuration in case there's a dedicated card. But there's no guarantee that the laptops have such a configuration. So such details along with the available BIOS options to tweak them would also be useful.

Thanks for reading!

—Aurabindo J

4 Thanks for writing and raising some interesting points. Allow me to respond to them one by one:

1. It's not that we don't pay attention to Linux; we've had FastTracks dedicated to Linux and we do regularly feature free linux alternatives to software as part of

Feedback for the August 2014 issue of Digit



our SOHO section, not to mention a dedicated section for Linux on our monthly DVDs. And we endeavour to do more.

2. The specifications mentioned for product reviews don't have a lot of in-depth information for want of space on edit pages. Moreover, you can always use NDISwrapper to use a Windows driver in Linux with a good amount of success. But we will keep this in mind and try to squeeze it in.
3. The performance impact of a MUX design vs MUXless design is something we're looking at so you might read an article on the same anytime soon.

—Mithun

✉ Dear Team Digit,

It's been a great feeling receiving your magazine every month since the first day I began reading it all the way back in 2004. In the July issue, it was good to see Robert and Siddharth's articles on both sides of one page. Both the editorials served as an introduction to the articles inside. Great article on Big Data. It looks like we're entering an era of common database. One can find our current location, what we're doing, what we're eating, etc...sounds like a Sci-Fi movie. Do we need to take any protective measures to safeguard our privacy? How? Can you dig out an article on this? It would be appreciated.

The gTLDs article is really helpful.

Last year, I attended Hosting Summit by seeing the advertisement in Digit magazine and asked this question: "Will custom-made TLDs be available and are we just entering that era?"

Jayesh added a feather to the hat of the magazine with his article. Devices are changing so rapidly that it's hard to choose the perfect gadget – whether it be about price, configuration, platform or supporting apps as they're also rapidly improving. This must be a question on all of our minds, even if we bought a gadget just a month ago because by then, we have a new OS version. Recently, I saw an ad by a renowned mobile network brand selling iPhone4s at a discounted price. Is it worth buying an ancient technology device just because it's from Apple?

Thanks for the introductory article on Ruby on Rails. It would be great to have a Fast Track on this. Thanks for sharing the Computex Taiwan moments with us. It was incredible.

I recently read a post by you on Facebook about how we're the lowest ranked country as far as high-speed Internet is concerned even though we have one of the largest databases of internet users that's seriously growing at full tilt. In Budget 2014, however, there's plenty of hope for internet users as the government